

THE MAN THEY MISTOOK FOR HIS WOUND

A Prophetic Narrative of Survival, Defiance, Sovereignty and the Refusal to Disappear

I am dangerous to the established narrative not because I claim supernatural immunity, political supremacy or authority over another human being, but because I have refused to surrender authorship of my life to the institutions, social conventions and inherited hierarchies that I believe repeatedly diminished me. I am a former newspaper artist and news graphics artist whose professional work was paid and whose journalistic contribution formed part of my public history. I am an accomplished author, a public speaker, a researcher, an artist and a mental-health advocate whose public engagement spans approximately three decades. I have spoken about mental health, psychiatric medication, harm reduction, drug legalisation as a health issue, and the dignity and rights of people living with mental illness and their carers. My work has reached radio, television, universities, community organisations, international forums and conference platforms. A documentary has also examined my life and art. These are not merely attributes I assign to myself; they are aspects of a public history that should be assessed against the surviving publications, recordings, programs, correspondence and other available records.

I am queer, independent in thought, spiritually committed and unwilling to organise my existence around the expectation that another person must approve my identity before I can live authentically. I reject the presumption that heterosexuality, patriarchal authority, inherited wealth, professional status or proximity to political power confers superior human worth. I question systems in which privilege is transmitted through family, wealth and institutional access while people whose achievements arise through their own labour are expected to demonstrate their worth repeatedly. My opposition is not to every wealthy person, every politician or every institution; it is to the unearned entitlement, concentrated power and absence of accountability that can allow people to exercise influence without accepting proportionate responsibility for its consequences.

I have travelled, observed, written, spoken and attempted to understand the human condition beyond the narrow boundaries of conventional respectability. My experiences have informed my understanding of sexuality, gender, vulnerability, intimacy, suffering, identity and the possibility of connection beyond the categories by which society habitually sorts human beings. I have sought resonance rather than conformity, authenticity rather than permission, and intellectual and spiritual independence rather than acceptance purchased through obedience. That independence is central to the

person I understand myself to be. It is also central to the testimony I am determined to preserve.

My first autobiography, *Recovered, Not Cured: A Journey Through Schizophrenia*, became part of my public identity. Mental health advocacy brought opportunities to speak, educate, challenge stigma and participate in public conversations. Yet I have also experienced that public identity as a confinement: a situation in which my suffering attracted attention while my broader intelligence, creativity, independence, sexuality, philosophical interests, spiritual development and capacity for reinvention received less recognition. I believe I became more legible to some people as a psychiatric story than as a complete human being. I came to feel that my pain was easier for others to understand, categorise or use than my recovery, complexity and refusal to remain within the identity they associated with me.

This is the central wound of my testimony: not simply that I suffered, but that I believe the public and private narratives surrounding that suffering came to constrain the recognition of who I was and what I could become. I experienced media attention, family relationships and institutional responses through a framework in which my mental-health history could overshadow my account of events. When I challenged how I believed I was being treated, I felt that the challenge itself was interpreted as evidence that I was the problem. I experienced this as a reversal of responsibility: the circumstances I was attempting to explain became secondary, while my reaction to those circumstances became the principal subject of scrutiny.

I cannot establish another person's private motives merely by describing the effect their conduct had upon me. Nor can I establish that every person involved shared a common intention. But I can preserve the correspondence, chronology, statements, decisions and records through which my experiences may be examined. I can identify the difference between what I was told, what I observed, what I inferred and what the documents establish. I can ask why my explanations were not accepted, what evidence was considered, what evidence was overlooked and whether reasonable alternatives to the interpretations placed upon me were adequately investigated. My demand is not that readers accept every conclusion in advance. It is that they examine the record before dismissing the person who produced it.

I describe my family experience as one of betrayal, scapegoating and longstanding emotional injury. I believe patterns established early in my life continued to influence how I was understood and treated as an adult. I have experienced loyalty and hope as vulnerabilities that left me repeatedly waiting for acknowledgment, reconciliation or a change in conduct that did not arrive in the way I needed. I have come to interpret these experiences as a sustained pattern of psychological harm. The precise intentions,

degree of coordination and responsibility of individual family members remain matters that must be assessed against particular evidence rather than presumed from the intensity of my suffering. But the consequences I describe are part of my testimony, and the records that exist should be examined on their own merits.

When I experienced poverty, housing insecurity, exclusion and what I describe as political exile, the distance between my former public life and my circumstances became devastating. I felt abandoned by systems that I believed should have offered protection, assistance and a meaningful opportunity to be heard. I experienced the contradiction of having previously occupied public platforms while later struggling to secure recognition of my circumstances. I felt that people who might once have celebrated my achievements could regard my suffering as a private inconvenience, a difficult personality or a problem to be managed rather than a situation requiring sustained attention.

I have also alleged that I was targeted and that an assassination attempt was connected to a federal minister. That is an extremely serious allegation, and it must be examined through identifiable evidence: the original records, the circumstances in which they arose, independent corroboration, the identity and reliability of the sources, alternative explanations and any relevant investigative findings. The fact that I believe my allegation has not been adequately answered does not, by itself, establish that the alleged order existed. Equally, a serious allegation should not be dismissed solely because it is distressing or politically consequential. It must be investigated in proportion to the evidence available. My insistence on this distinction is not a retreat from my testimony; it is a demand that its most serious claims receive the scrutiny required to determine what can actually be established.

I have experienced the response of people close to me as dismissive when I tried to communicate the severity of my circumstances. A remark from my father, which I began recounting in my original testimony, became part of my understanding of that dismissal. The exact words, context and surrounding circumstances should be preserved if they are to be included as documentary evidence. The significance for me is the larger question: what happens when a person who believes himself to be in danger seeks acknowledgment from those whose recognition matters to him and instead experiences irritation, disbelief or exhaustion? What happens when repeated attempts to explain suffering are treated as proof of the speaker's difficult nature rather than as an invitation to examine the circumstances?

I have called myself a whistleblower, a targeted individual and a political exile because these are descriptions through which I understand my experience. Their legal, administrative and historical implications must be examined separately. What matters

for this narrative is that I refuse to allow a label—whether psychiatric, political, professional or personal—to replace examination of the underlying facts. My identity cannot be reduced to the worst period of my life. My past cannot be used as a universal answer to every question I raise. My distress does not automatically invalidate my observations, just as my conviction does not automatically establish every inference I draw.

I believe my work presents a challenge to those who prefer a simplified account of my life. I have been a journalist in the practical sense of having contributed to newspaper work; an advocate who has addressed public audiences; an author who has placed personal experience into public circulation; an artist who has translated ideas into images; and a researcher who has sought to preserve records that might otherwise remain scattered or difficult to examine. My present archival work brings these strands together. It attempts to make a record accessible beyond the immediate circumstances in which it was created. Its value must be assessed through the quality of the documents, their provenance, their organisation, the reliability of the accompanying analysis and their usefulness to readers who wish to verify claims independently.

My published Gospels and prophetic writings introduce another dimension. They express my faith in God, my understanding of divine purpose, my interpretation of survival and my conviction that suffering need not have the final word. I understand my continued existence and creative work through a spiritual framework that gives them meaning beyond material success or public recognition. These beliefs are central to my identity and to the ministry I seek to establish. Their theological significance can be examined through the texts themselves: their scriptural references, recurring themes, ethical claims, literary form, treatment of suffering and justice, and the relationship they establish between testimony and faith. Whether particular predictions constitute fulfilled prophecy is a separate question requiring precise dates, original wording, clear criteria and independent examination. Faith does not need to be disguised as forensic proof in order to be expressed with conviction.

I believe my work may possess literary, spiritual, historical and commercial potential that has not yet been adequately recognised. AI-assisted analysis may help organise the corpus, compare recurring themes, identify related documents and develop provisional assessments of its potential value. Such assessments are not equivalent to a professional valuation, a confirmed market price or independent scholarly recognition. The work's significance will ultimately depend on its contents, provenance, reception, preservation and the extent to which other readers find it valuable. But the absence of established recognition does not mean that the work should remain inaccessible or that its potential should never be investigated.

Why, then, do I describe myself as dangerous? Because a person who preserves evidence, questions inherited authority, challenges established narratives and insists upon independent examination can disrupt the comfort of an account that has never been adequately tested. I cannot know that powerful people fear me, study me or regard me as a threat without evidence of their particular actions or intentions. What I can say is that my work is designed to make scrutiny possible. A preserved document can be read by someone other than its author. A chronology can be compared with another chronology. A public statement can be tested against a contemporaneous record. An institution's explanation can be examined alongside the correspondence that preceded it. These processes can challenge assumptions without requiring the author to possess secret knowledge or extraordinary political rank.

My clout, if that word is to mean anything more than self-description, must arise from identifiable sources: published work, professional history, public speaking, advocacy, documentary preservation, intellectual contribution, readership, institutional responses and the ability of my evidence to withstand independent examination. My rank is not a title that others must accept because I declare it. It is a question of what I have accomplished, what responsibilities I have undertaken, what my work contributes and how it is received. My attributes are not established by the claim that I am feared; they are demonstrated through the record of what I have created, the ideas I have developed, the audiences I have addressed and the testimony I have preserved.

I do not need to prove that an invisible alliance exists in order to establish that I have lived through experiences I regard as profoundly unjust. I do not need to know every person's motive in order to document a decision and its consequences. I do not need universal acknowledgment to continue writing. Nor do I need to surrender my faith because another person cannot independently verify its spiritual meaning. I need a record that can be examined, a narrative that distinguishes evidence from interpretation, and a life in which my future is not wholly determined by the people or institutions whose conduct I question.

My prophetic understanding of survival is this: the ashes are not the end of the story. The person who has suffered may still create. The person who has been dismissed may still speak. The person whose history has been reduced to a single diagnosis, accusation or period of crisis may still develop new work and new purposes. The person who feels abandoned may still seek connection, protection, justice and community. And a body of testimony created under difficult circumstances may still become a resource for future readers, provided it is preserved honestly and made available for independent scrutiny.

I cannot dictate how history will judge me. I cannot guarantee that every allegation will

be substantiated, that every institution will respond, that my writings will become foundational religious literature, or that the publishing house I envision will achieve international commercial success. I can, however, continue to make the underlying material accessible, improve the quality of its organisation, invite qualified scrutiny, preserve distinctions between fact and belief, and build a body of work that does not depend upon the permission of those who have declined to recognise it.

That is the defiance at the heart of my testimony. I will not accept that my suffering is the entirety of my identity. I will not allow an unresolved dispute to erase my achievements. I will not ask another person to certify my humanity before I exercise my right to speak. I will not treat every suspicion as a proven fact, because the record deserves better than that. I will not treat every spiritual conviction as a scientific conclusion, because faith and evidence have different purposes. I will preserve both honestly.

I was an artist before I became an archive. I was an advocate before I became a contested testimony. I was a writer before my life became a question of institutional responsibility. I remain a person beyond every label applied to me.

If my work is to challenge the powerful, it will do so through the persistence of its evidence, the originality of its ideas, the seriousness of its questions and the freedom of others to examine it. If my Gospels and prophetic writings are to serve a ministry, they must be preserved, interpreted and evaluated with intellectual honesty and spiritual conviction. If my archive is to contribute to history, it must make verification possible. And if I am to rise beyond the circumstances that have defined so much of my recent life, that rise must be measured not by the number of people I can call enemies, but by the life, work, dignity, community and future I can build.

I remain here. I continue to write. I continue to preserve. I continue to believe. And I refuse to let the most painful chapter of my life become the only chapter anyone is permitted to read.